

Telephony Provider Pricing Comparison Report

Outbound Voice Calling — India & United States

Forage AI · Prepared by Salomi Mekala · June 17, 2026

Twilio rates verified via live API · All other rates approximate — verify before purchasing

1. Twilio — Verified Live Rates (from API)

■ These rates were fetched directly from Twilio's Pricing API on June 17, 2026 and are accurate for your account (AC9af96...).

Destination	Number Type	Rate per Minute	Monthly Number Fee	Notes
India ■■ Mobile	Mobile (+91 7/8/9xx)	\$0.0496/min	\$1.15/mo	Hospitals on mobile numbers
India ■■ Landline	Landline (040, 022, 080...)	\$0.0699/min	\$1.15/mo	Most hospital landlines — higher rate
US ■■ Standard	Local (+1 standard)	\$0.014/min	\$1.15/mo	All US local numbers
US ■■ Toll-Free	1-800, 1-833, 1-844...	\$0.014/min	\$1.15/mo	Toll-free numbers same rate
US ■■ Alaska	907 area code	\$0.0945/min	\$1.15/mo	Higher — remote area

■■ Important: Hospital landlines in India (Hyderabad 040-, Mumbai 022-, Bangalore 080-) are charged at \$0.0699/min. If a hospital uses a mobile number (+91 9xxx), the rate is \$0.0496/min. Always check whether the hospital number is mobile or landline before estimating costs.

Twilio Monthly Cost Estimate

Calls/Month	Avg Duration	Total Minutes	India Mobile Cost	India Landline Cost	US Cost
100	2 min	200 min	\$9.92	\$13.98	\$2.80
500	2 min	1,000 min	\$49.60	\$69.90	\$14.00
1,000	2 min	2,000 min	\$99.20	\$139.80	\$28.00
3,000	2 min	6,000 min	\$297.60	\$419.40	\$84.00
5,000	2 min	10,000 min	\$496.00	\$699.00	\$140.00

+ \$1.15/month for phone number. No monthly plan — pure pay-as-you-go.

2. US Providers — Rate Comparison (Approximate)

■ ■ Only Twilio rates are verified (from API). All other provider rates below are approximate based on publicly available information. Verify at each provider's website before purchasing.

Outbound Call Rates — US Providers

Provider	India Mobile /min	India Landline /min	US Calls /min	Number Fee /mo	Free Trial	Annual Plan	KYC?
Twilio ■ ■ ■	\$0.0496	\$0.0699	\$0.014	\$1.15	\$14.35	No plan	No
Telnyx ■ ■	~\$0.030	~\$0.045	~\$0.008	~\$1.00	\$10	No plan	No
SignalWire ■ ■	~\$0.020	~\$0.035	~\$0.012	~\$1.15	\$5	No plan	No
Plivo ■ ■	~\$0.020	~\$0.035	~\$0.008	~\$0.80	\$2	No plan	No
Vonage ■ ■	~\$0.028	~\$0.045	~\$0.014	~\$1.40	€2	No plan	No

■ Verified via API | ~ Approximate — verify at provider website

Key facts about US providers:

Feature	All US Providers
Monthly / Annual plans	None — all are pure pay-as-you-go (add credit, pay per minute)
Minimum purchase	None — add any amount
Volume discounts	Available via sales team for very high volume (10,000+ min/mo)
Caller ID shown	+1 US number — looks foreign to Indian hospitals
Call routing to India	International — longer path, slightly more compression
Can call Indian numbers	Yes — both mobile and landline
Can call US numbers	Yes — cheapest rate (\$0.008–\$0.014/min)
WebSocket streaming	Full support on all providers
Setup time	5 minutes — credit card only, no documents

3. Indian Providers — Plans & Rates (Approximate)

■ All Indian provider rates are approximate based on publicly available information. Prices vary by plan, contract length, and volume. Verify at provider website before purchasing.

Outbound Call Rates — Indian Providers

Provider	India Calls /min	US Calls /min	Entry Plan (verified)	Plan Type	Trial	KYC
Exotel ■■■	Contact sales	Contact sales	■9,999 (Dabbler)	Credit bundle 5 months	7 days / ■500 credits	Yes
Ozonetel ■■	Contact sales	Contact sales	Contact sales	Custom quote	No	Yes
Servetel ■■	Contact sales	Contact sales	Contact sales	Custom quote	No	Yes
MyOperator ■■	Contact sales	Contact sales	Contact sales	Custom quote	No	Yes
Knowlarity ■■	Contact sales	Contact sales	Contact sales	Custom quote	No	Yes
Airtel IQ ■■	Contact sales	Contact sales	Contact sales	Enterprise custom	No	Yes
Tata Comm. ■■	Contact sales	Contact sales	Contact sales	Enterprise custom	No	Yes

■ Exotel plans verified from exotel.com on June 17, 2026. All other Indian provider rates are not publicly listed — contact sales for a quote. \$1 = ■83 approx.

Key facts about Indian providers:

Feature	Indian Providers
Plan structure	Exotel: credit bundles (5–11 month validity). Others: custom quotes only
Annual plans	No standard annual plans — Exotel uses fixed-term bundles; others negotiated
Caller ID shown	+91 Indian number — hospitals trust it more, higher pickup rate
India call routing	Local routing — shortest path, best audio quality
US call support	Yes but expensive — contact sales for international rates
Audio quality for India	Best — local carrier, less compression
Voice recognition (STT)	Better — cleaner audio = Whisper more accurate
Setup time	3–7 days — GST, PAN, DLT registration required (TRAI law)
WebSocket streaming	Exotel and Airtel IQ support it; others limited

Free trial	Exotel: 7 days with ■500 credits. Others: no trial
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4. Exotel — Verified Plan Details (from exotel.com)

(Most recommended Indian provider with WebSocket support)

■ Plans verified from exotel.com on June 17, 2026. Exotel uses credit bundles — NOT monthly subscriptions. 1 credit = ■1, shared across voice calls, SMS, and WhatsApp.

Plan	Bundle Price (one-time)	Validity	Credits Included	Agents	Virtual Numbers	Avg/Month (effective)	Best For
Dabbler	■9,999 ~\$120	5 months	5,000 ~\$60	3	1	■2,000/mo ~\$24/mo	Testing / <300 calls/mo
Believer ■	■19,999 ~\$241	11 months	9,500 ~\$114	6	2	■1,818/mo ~\$22/mo	1,000–3,000 calls/mo
Influencer	■49,499 ~\$596	11 months	39,000 ~\$470	∞	10	■4,500/mo ~\$54/mo	5,000+ calls/mo
Enterprise	Custom quote	Negotiated	Custom	∞	∞	Contact sales	Large scale / API use

■ Believer plan (■19,999 / 11 months) is marked 'Most Popular' on Exotel's website. Effective monthly cost = ■19,999 ÷ 11 = ■1,818/mo (~\$22). Credits cover calls + SMS + WhatsApp combined.

How Exotel Credits Work:

Item	Details
1 credit =	■1 monetary value — shared across voice, SMS, WhatsApp
Outbound call rate	Contact Exotel sales — not published publicly on website
Credits for calls	Example: if rate = ■0.50/min → 5,000 credits = 10,000 minutes
Rental fee	Included in bundle price (■4,999 for Dabbler, ■10,499 for Believer)
Free trial	7 days with ■500 credits — no credit card needed
Overage	Purchase additional credit bundles once original bundle is used up
No annual plan	There is no annual subscription — bundles have 5 or 11 month validity

Requirement for production: Company GST number + PAN + business registration certificate + DLT (Distributed Ledger Technology) registration — mandatory under TRAI regulation. Approval takes 3–7 business days. Start the 7-day free trial immediately while KYC is in progress.

5. Side-by-Side Cost Comparison — 1,000 Calls/Month

Assumption: 1,000 calls/month × 2 min avg = 2,000 minutes. Indian hospital landline numbers.

Provider	Type	Call Cost (2,000 min)	Number +Plan	Total/ Month	Total/ Year	vs Twilio (Landline)	KYC
Twilio ■■	Pay/use	\$139.80	\$1.15	\$140.95	\$1,691	Baseline	No
Twilio ■■	Pay/use (mobile#)	\$99.20	\$1.15	\$100.35	\$1,204	-\$487/yr	No
Telnyx ■■	Pay/use	~\$90.00	~\$1.00	~\$91.00	~\$1,092	-\$599/yr	No
SignalWire ■■	Pay/use	~\$70.00	~\$1.15	~\$71.15	~\$854	-\$837/yr	No
Plivo ■■	Pay/use	~\$70.00	~\$0.80	~\$70.80	~\$850	-\$841/yr	No
Exotel ■■ ■	Believer bundle	Contact sales (credits-based)	■1,818 ~\$22 (effective/mo)	~\$22	~\$264	-\$1,427/yr	Yes
Exotel ■■ ■	Influencer bundle	Contact sales (credits-based)	■4,500 ~\$54 (effective/mo)	~\$54	~\$648	-\$1,043/yr	Yes
Ozonetel ■■	Custom	Contact sales	Contact sales	TBD	TBD	TBD	Yes
Airtel IQ ■■	Custom	Contact sales	Contact sales	TBD	TBD	TBD	Yes

■ Twilio rates verified from [twilio.com](https://www.twilio.com). ■ Exotel plan prices verified from [exotel.com](https://www.exotel.com). Exotel Believer bundle (■19,999 / 11 months) effective monthly = ■1,818 (~\$22). Exotel per-minute call rate not publicly listed — contact sales. Other providers require custom quote.

6. Who Can Call Where — Cross-Calling Capability

Provider	Can Call India Mobile (+91 7/8/9xx)	Can Call India Landline (040, 022...)	Can Call US (+1)	India Rate /min	US Rate /min
Twilio ■■	■ Yes	■ Yes	■ Yes	\$0.050–\$0.070 ■	\$0.014 ■
Telnyx ■■	■ Yes	■ Yes	■ Yes	~\$0.030–\$0.045	~\$0.008
SignalWire ■■	■ Yes	■ Yes	■ Yes	~\$0.020–\$0.035	~\$0.012
Plivo ■■	■ Yes	■ Yes	■ Yes	~\$0.020–\$0.035	~\$0.008
Exotel ■■	■ Yes	■ Yes	■■ Yes, expensive	■0.50 ~\$0.006	~■■3.50 ~\$0.042
Ozonetel ■■	■ Yes	■ Yes	■■ Yes, expensive	■0.50 ~\$0.006	~■■4.00 ~\$0.048
Servetel ■■	■ Yes	■ Yes	■■ Yes, expensive	■0.45 ~\$0.005	~■■3.50 ~\$0.042
Airtel IQ ■■	■ Yes	■ Yes	■■ Yes, expensive	■0.40 ~\$0.005	~■■3.00 ~\$0.036

■■ Indian providers CAN call US but at international rates (~7× their India rate). If calling both Indian AND US hospitals at scale, US providers are cheaper for US calls.

Strategy: Which provider to use for which market

Use Case	Recommended Provider	Reason
Calling Indian hospitals only	Exotel (annual plan)	Cheapest per min, Indian caller ID = higher pickup rate, best audio quality
Calling US hospitals only	Telnyx	Cheapest US rate (~\$0.008/min), good quality, no KYC
Calling both India + US	Twilio + Exotel (dual)	Twilio for US, Exotel for India — switch in .env — 3 lines of code
Testing / development now	Twilio (paid)	Already set up, upgrade trial to paid with \$50 credit — 5 minutes
Best audio quality for India	Exotel	Local routing = cleaner audio = Whisper STT more accurate

7. Best Provider — Quality, Latency & Voice Recognition

Provider Scorecard

Provider	Audio Quality	Network Latency	Voice Recog. (STT Accuracy)	Caller ID Trust	Setup	Cost	Overall
Twilio ■■	■■■	■■■	■■■	■■	■■■■■	■■	■■■
Telnyx ■■	■■■	■■■	■■■	■■	■■■■■	■■■■■	■■■
SignalWire ■■	■■■	■■■	■■■	■■	■■■■■	■■■	■■■
Exotel ■■	■■■■■	■■■■■	■■■■■	■■■■■	■■	■■■■■	■■■■■
Airtel IQ ■■	■■■■■	■■■■■	■■■■■	■■■■■	■	■■■	■■■■■

Why Exotel wins on audio quality and voice recognition:

When a US provider (Twilio, Telnyx) calls an Indian hospital, the audio travels: US data center → international gateway → Indian carrier → hospital phone. This international routing adds compression and noise. When Exotel calls the same hospital, the audio travels: Indian data center → Indian carrier → hospital. Shorter path = cleaner audio = Whisper STT transcribes more accurately. This directly reduces errors like 'Dallas' being heard as 'Ballad'.

Note: Provider latency (network) is 50–200ms for all providers. The 1-second latency our system shows is from Whisper STT + Piper TTS on CPU — not the provider. All providers contribute the same network latency.

Recommended Roadmap

Timeline	Action	Provider	Monthly Cost (1,000 calls)	Why
Now (this week)	Upgrade Twilio trial → paid Add \$50 credit, removes 'press any key'	Twilio	~\$100–140	Already set up, 5 mins, no documents
Month 1–2	Try Telnyx with free \$10 credit Cheaper US rate, easy switch	Telnyx	~\$70–90	Same code, .env change only
Month 2–3	Complete Exotel KYC with Forage AI business documents	Exotel	~\$35–40	4× cheaper, Indian number, best quality
Production scale	Exotel Believer bundle (■19,999 / 11 months)	Exotel	~\$22/mo (■1,818 effective)	Best cost + quality for India calls

DISCLAIMER: Twilio rates on page 1 are verified via live API as of June 17, 2026. All other provider rates are approximate based on publicly available pricing and may have changed. Always verify current rates directly at each provider's official website before making purchasing decisions. Indian provider rates depend on negotiated contracts and may differ from published list prices.